

The Night Shelf

Give the night back to reading.

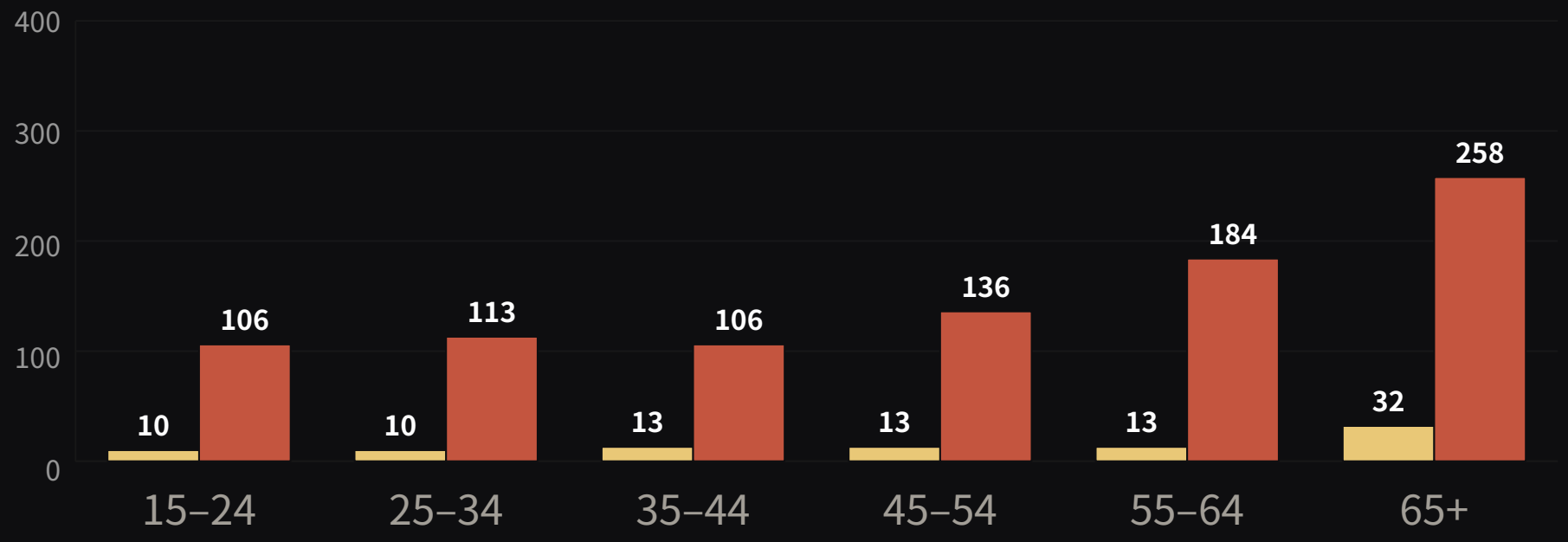
Fog & Fern Books — late autumn campaign

Example pitch. Fog & Fern Books, its figures, constraints and this campaign are fictional; every research finding cited is real and sourced.

There are sixteen minutes left

16 min
reading, per day

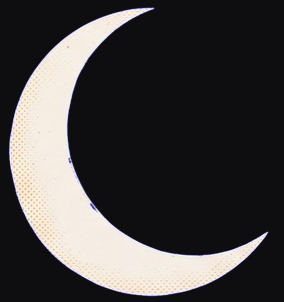
2 h 37 m
television, per day



The youngest band reads for ten minutes a day and watches television for one hour forty-six.

US Bureau of Labor Statistics, American Time Use Survey, 2025 annual averages. Published hours converted to minutes.

The last hour is already taken



Half of adults are on a screen in bed every day.

Another third are there most days or several days a week; a quarter choose the phone over sleep.

Each extra hour of it costs 24 minutes of sleep.

One more hour of screen time after getting into bed raised the odds of insomnia symptoms by 59 percent.

A book in bed does the opposite.

In a randomised trial, 42 percent of people who read in bed said their sleep improved, against 28 percent who did not.

Sources: American Academy of Sleep Medicine, 2,007 US adults, June 2025; SHOT2022 in Frontiers in Psychiatry, 45,202 students, March 2025; The People's Trial in Trials 22:873, 991 participants, 2021.

What the work has to do

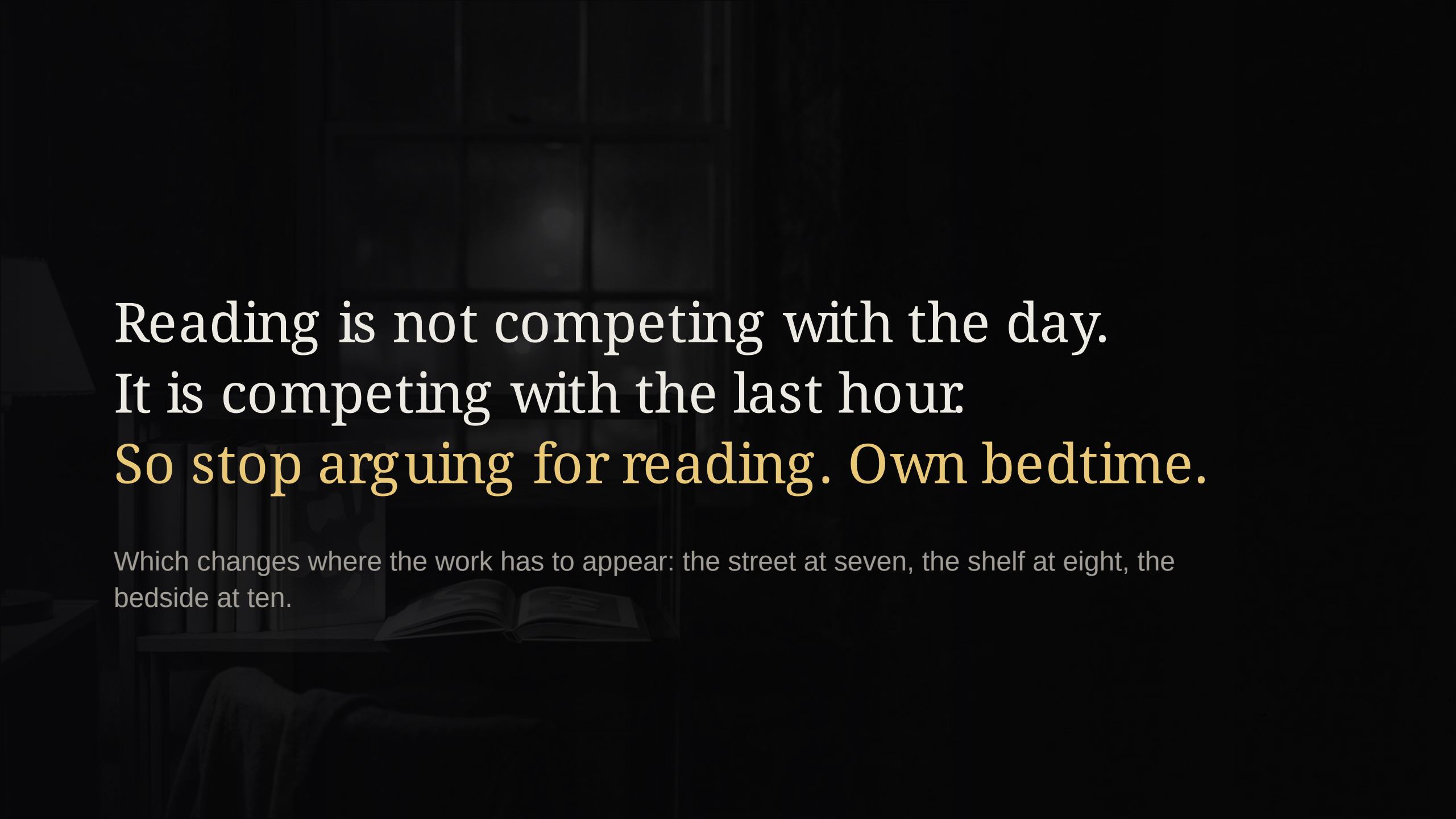
Make Fog & Fern the place a reader thinks of at nine in the evening.

No paid media beyond the shop's own frontage and channels.

One season — six weeks from first paste-up to last event.

Five people, all of whom already work full shifts.

Shop scale, staffing, budget and timing are illustrative and belong to this fictional client.



Reading is not competing with the day.
It is competing with the last hour.
So stop arguing for reading. Own bedtime.

Which changes where the work has to appear: the street at seven, the shelf at eight, the bedside at ten.

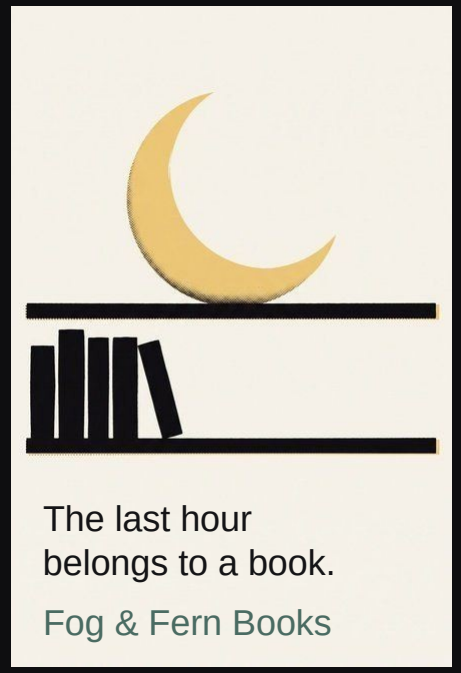


The last hour belongs to a book.

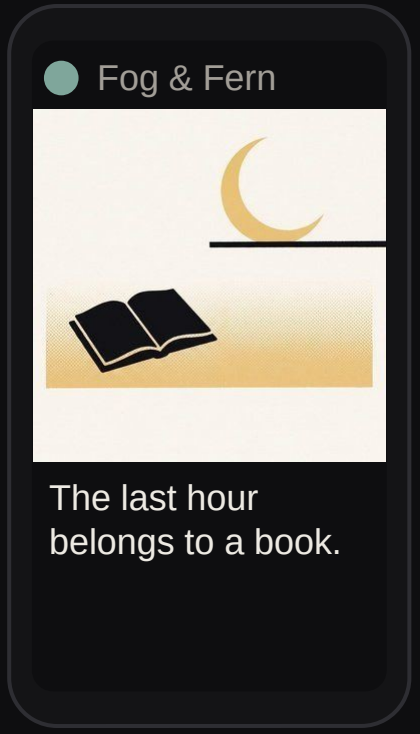
The Night Shelf — the books chosen for the hour before sleep, and a shop that stays open into it.


The last hour
belongs to a book.
Fog & Fern Books

It runs everywhere the hour is spent



Street poster
the walk home



Phone
already in hand



Shop window
the lightbox the shop already owns



Bookmark
goes home

All four are mockups of proposed executions; no placement is shown that the shop does not already own.

The identity, in use

Type voice

The last hour belongs to a book.

Georgia for everything the campaign says; a quiet sans for everything the shop adds later.

Palette, by job

Night ink	Lamplight	Paper cream	Fern
the ground	the only light	what readers touch	the shop's own mark

The mark, at three scales



poster window bookmark



Lamplight is a light source, never a type colour.



Fern marks only the surfaces the shop itself owns.

Ember appears only where a screen is being referred to; nothing else in the campaign is red.

Tone and craft

Unhurried

Warm, printed, made by the shop.

Uncoated cream stock, two inks, no laminate.

Photographed at night in the shop, not on a set.

Every line written to be read aloud in one breath.



Something the shop made, not something it bought.



At real size, from the far pavement, the poster still reads.

Mockup at the window's real dimensions, seen at ordinary standing eye level.

What it takes to make

Print Social In-store Events

brief → artwork → print → paste-up → launch → events → six weeks

Deliverable	Format	Quantity	Lead time	Owner
Street poster	2:3, two inks	120	3 weeks	Print supplier A
Window lightbox panel	1180 × 340 mm	1	3 weeks	Print supplier A
Social film and stills	1:1 and 9:16	9 posts	2 weeks	Shop team
Printed bookmark	55 × 180 mm	3,000	2 weeks	Print supplier B
Shelf talker	A6, two inks	40	2 weeks	Print supplier B
Evening event series	90 minutes	6 evenings	6 weeks	Shop team
Local radio read	30 seconds	4 spots	4 weeks	Shop team

Every quantity, lead time and owner above is illustrative for this fictional client; nothing here is a quotation.



How you will know it worked

If the shop is busier between eight and ten in the evening in week six than in week one, the idea worked.

Approve The Night Shelf for late autumn.

Sources

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